A right line AE and a curve ABC cut each other at the given point A. From the curve points B and C we let fall the ordinates BD and CE, drawn at a fixed angle to the base, so that two triangles $\triangle ABD$ and $\triangle ACE$ are formed beneath the curve. As B and C slide down toward A both triangles dwindle to nothing, yet we may still ask the limiting value of their ratio. Newton's claim is that this ultimate ratio is the duplicate ratio of the sides, namely $AD^2 : AE^2$.